



PhD Regulations, 2021

Assam down town University

(4thAmended AdtU PhD Regulations in consonance with UGC M.Phil/PhD Regulations 2016, shall be applicable to all PhD programmes offered by the University, shall be applicable from 1st December 2020)

Approved by the Academic Council, Assam down town University in its 38th meeting held on 31/07/2021.

1. PREAMBLE:

- 1.1. These regulations shall be called as “PhD Regulations, 2021 of Assam down town University (AdtU)” which govern the policies and procedures in respect of the PhD programme of the university including selection, admission, impact of research work, conduct of course work and examinations, evaluation of progress and thesis and award PhD degree, certification and other related matters and guidelines.
- 1.2. This set of AdtU PhD Regulations has been developed through the process of updating and making amendment, modification wherever necessary, and incorporation of new clauses deemed appropriate and with the approval of the Academic Council and the Board of Management thereof.
- 1.3. These updated regulations shall come into force with effect from the academic year 2020-21.
- 1.4. The regulations shall be binding on all the candidates considered in the process for selection and admission and also PhD research scholars undergoing the said Degree programme at AdtU and shall be binding on all parties concerned including the research scholars, faculty and staff, besides the Departments, Faculties and Institution Authorities.

- 1.5. In the event of any difficulty arising at any point of time during implementation of any clause(s) of this regulations or in interpretation thereof, the decision of the Honorable Vice Chancellor shall be final and binding on all concerned.
- 1.6. If any difference of opinion or dispute arises in this set of regulations or any clause(s) at any point of time shall be addressed to the Board of Management. The decision of the Board of Management (BOM) shall be final and binding on all parties concerned.
- 1.7. Any matter(s) not covered by the clauses of this Regulation pertaining to the PhD degree programme of the university shall be decided by the University Research Council (URC), Academic Council, and Board of Management (BOM) of Assam down town University as and when necessary.

IMPORTANT NOTES:

- 1.8. The 'PhD Thesis Writing Guidelines' as provided in the present 'AdtU PhD Regulation 2021' shall have to be followed by all the PhD scholars of the university irrespective of their year of admission/registration w.e.f. the date of implementation of the Regulation.
- 1.9. The process/procedure of pre-submission seminar presentation, anti-plagiarism Check, Submission of abstract and thesis as provided in the present 'AdtU PhD Regulation 2021' shall have to be followed by all the PhD scholars of the university irrespective of their year of admission/registration w.e.f. the date of implementation of the Regulation.
- 1.10. The following Clauses of 'AdtU PhD Regulation 2021' shall be applicable to all the PhD scholars pursuing PhD degree programme in the university irrespective of their year of admission/registration and are to be followed while processing for award of the degree.
 - Clause No. 20: Anti-Plagiarism Check
 - Clause No. 22: Appointment of Examiners and Receipt of Reports
 - Clause No. 23: Examination of Thesis
 - Clause No. 24: Submission of Hard Bound Thesis
 - Clause No. 25: Award of Degree
 - Clause No. 26: Issue of Certificate and information to UGC
 - Clause No. 27: Payment of Tuition & Other Fees
 - Clause No. 28: Duration of Programme
 - Clause No. 29: Cancellation of PhD Admission & Registration
 - Clause No. 30: Confidentiality and Copyright of the Thesis
 - Clause No. 32: Change of Supervisor
 - Clause No. 35: Grievance Redress System

- 1.11. The PhD scholars admitted/registered during and prior to 2017-18 academic session will be govern by the provision of Clause no. 15 (particularly the Clause Nos. 15.6 and 15.7) together with Clause Nos. 17.2 and 17.3 regarding publication of research papers and fulfillment of academic prerequisites for award of the degree as specified under the AdtU PhD regulation, 2018 (Amended).

2. THE UNIVERSITY RESEARCH COUNCIL (URC)

- 2.1. University Research Council (URC) is responsible to examine and coordinate the research programmes leading to the PhD Degree.

- 2.2. **Formation of URC:** The URC will oversee the PhD programme of Assam down town University (AdtU). The URC shall consist of the following members:

(i). The Vice Chancellor	Chairperson
(ii). Pro-Vice Chancellor	Member
(iii). The Dean of Studies	Member
(iv). The Registrar	Member
(v). Chairperson, Research	Member
(vi). Chairperson (Executive) of all FRCs	Member
(vii). Dean of Research	Member
(viii). Director (Quality & Process)	Member
(ix). Deans/Director, Research & Outreach of all Faculties	Member
(x). Controller of Examinations	Member
(xi). Registrar (Academic)/Deputy Registrar (Academic)	Member
(xii). PhD Coordinator	Member Secretary

Special Invitee: The Chairperson, URC may invite special invitee(s) to attend a meeting of URC as and when necessary.

- 2.3. **Conduct of the Meetings:** The URC normally shall sit at every two months interval. However, the Chairperson may call for the special meeting(s) with specific agenda items at any time in case of urgent need and exigency.

2.4. Functions of the University Research Council (URC):

- 2.4.1. The URC shall plan, implement, regulate and review the entire PhD programme of the University.
- 2.4.2. The URC also will extend its cooperation to the Controller of Examinations (CoE) in conducting the Assam down town University-Research Entrance Test (AdtU-RET).
- 2.4.3. The URC shall fix the schedule of course work classes, allocation of resource persons and shall help the CoE to organize the course work examination.
- 2.4.4. The URC shall take decisions regarding the admission of candidates to the PhD programme, and allotment to the appropriate Faculty of Study and Research.
- 2.4.5. The URC shall grant the approval of PhD research Supervisors to be ratified by the Academic Council.
- 2.4.6. On the basis of reports from the examiners, the Chairperson, URC decides the holding of viva-voce and notifies through the COE.
- 2.4.7. The URC shall receive the six monthly progress reports from the PhDresearch scholars duly approved by the respective FRCs.
- 2.4.8. The quorum for meetings of the URC is two-thirds of the total number of members.

3. FACULTY RESEARCH COMMITTEE (FRC)

- 3.1. FRC is the intermediate body to examine and coordinate the research programmes leading to the PhD Degree.

3.2. FRC under AdtU: AdtU has the following FRCs:

- i. FRC of Commerce and Management
- ii. FRC of Humanities and Social Sciences
- iii. FRC of Sciences
- iv. FRC of Engineering and Technology
- v. FRC of Pharmaceutical Science
- vi. FRC of Paramedical Sciences
- vii. FRC of Nursing

3.3. **Composition of FRC:** The FRC shall have the following members

- (i). Chairperson (Adviser): The Pro-Vice Chancellor/Chairman, Research/ Dean, Research/ Adviser/Dean of other Faculty of Study.
- (ii). Chairperson (Executive): Dean of concerned Faculty of Study
- (iii). External Member: One member from a faculty other than the parent Faculty of Study of the University.
- (iv). All the Supervisors of the faculty with the rank of Associate Professor and above. In absence of any Associate Professors in a position in a Faculty as PhD Supervisor, the senior Assistant Professor(s) supervising PhD scholars may be included.

Chairperson (Executive) may invite special invitee to an FRC meeting as and when necessary.

3.4. **Conduct of Meeting:** The FRC normally shall sit every month. However, the Chairperson (Executive) may call for special meeting(s) with specific agenda items at any time in case of exigency. The quorum for meetings of FRC is two-thirds of the total number of members.

3.5. **Functions of the Faculty Research Committees (FRC):**

- 3.5.1. The FRC shall ensure that a file is maintained against each PhD research scholar of the Faculty and all documents pertaining to the scholar during his/her tenure in AdtU is maintained in chronological order and compact manner.
- 3.5.2. The FRCs shall find out the vacancy position of scholars to be admitted Supervisor-wise in their respective Faculty of Studies.
- 3.5.3. On request from CoE the FRCs will conduct the interview component of AdtU-RET for their respective Faculty of Studies.
- 3.5.4. FRCs shall scrutinize all synopses of research proposals submitted by the scholars of their respective faculty of studies who have successfully completed the course work.
- 3.5.5. FRC shall ask the scholar to present his/her synopsis before it.
- 3.5.6. If the FRC is satisfied with the synopsis and its subsequent presentation, the FRC will recommend the scholar for registration.
- 3.5.7. The six monthly progress reports of the scholars, duly signed by the Supervisors will be received by the respective FRCs along with the attendance report to be maintained by the concerned Supervisor and countersigned by the Dean in regard to the scholar's residency period. Every PhD scholar will make a power point presentation of their six monthly progress reports of their works before the FRC. On successful presentation of the progress report, the FRC may approve the same and forward it to URC.

3.5.8. The thesis of the PhD scholar will be checked by the Supervisor(s) and after their recommendation, the FRC will arrange for the pre-submission presentation seminar. On successful presentation, the FRC may recommend submission of the abstract and thesis by the research scholar. In general, PhD related communications between the University and the research scholars will be online (ERP module based). Respective member secretaries of various FRCs will supervise this process and will update the status to the respective Chairperson for further processing/action.

4. VARIOUS PhD PROGRAMMES OF ADTU:

4.1. AdtU offers PhD degree in different disciplines/departments under the different Faculty of Study. The detailed list of disciplines/departments under various Faculty of Studies of AdtU is offering PhD programme is as follows:

Table 1: List of different approved Disciplines/Departments for PhD degree

Faculty of Study	Disciplines/Departments	
Pharmaceutical Science	Pharmaceutical Science	
Science	i. Biotechnology ii. Biochemistry iii. Botany iv. Chemistry v. Food, Nutrition and Dietetics(FND)	vi. Mathematics vii. Microbiology viii. Physics ix. Statistics x. Zoology
Humanities and Social Science	i. Psychology ii. Sociology	iii. Social Work iv. English
Paramedical Science	i. Dialysis ii. Emergency & Critical Care iii. Medical Laboratory Technology iv. Physiotherapy	v. Operation Theatre vi. Optometry vii. Radiology and Imaging Technology viii. Trauma Emergency and Disaster Management
Commerce & Management	i. Hospitality and Tourism Management ii. Management	
Engineering & Technology	i. Civil Engineering ii. Computer Science and Engineering iii. Mechanical Engineering	
Nursing	Nursing	

- 4.2. A PhD research scholar registered in a department of a faculty under a Supervisor from the same or different discipline/department of the same or different faculty, on successful completion of his/her research work and fulfilment of all other required conditions, will be eligible for the award of the degree of Doctor of Philosophy in that discipline in which he/she had registered.
- 4.3. AdtU can also allow the candidate to pursue the PhD research work of multidisciplinary in nature. However, the degree will be awarded for the discipline/department in which he/she is registered.

5. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR ADMISSION TO PhD PROGRAMME:

- 5.1. Candidates for admission to the PhD programme shall have a Master's degree from a recognized university or a professional degree declared equivalent to the Master's degree by the corresponding statutory regulatory body, with at least 55% marks in aggregate or its equivalent grade 'B' in the UGC 7-point scale (or an equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed) or an equivalent degree from a foreign educational institution accredited by an Assessment and Accreditation Agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country for the purpose of assessing, accrediting or assuring quality and standards of educational institutions.
- 5.2. A relaxation of 5% of marks, from 55% to 50%, or an equivalent relaxation of grade, may be allowed for those belonging to SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/differently able and other categories of candidates as per the direction of the UGC received by AdtU time to time, or for those who had obtained their Master's degree prior to 19th September, 1991. The eligibility marks of 55% (or an equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed) and the relaxation of 5% to the categories mentioned above are permissible based only on the qualifying marks without including the grace mark procedures.
- 5.3. Occasionally the university finds candidates with less than 55% in MSc with extraordinary research aptitude and idea, may be considered for admission subject to a critical evaluation of the claim of high order of research of aptitude by the URC. On recommendation of such candidate by URC, the Vice Chancellor may at his discretion permit admission of such candidate.

6. ADTU RESEARCH ENTRANCE TEST (ADTU-RET) AND PUBLICATION OF RESULT:

6.1. AdtU-RET:

- 6.1.1. The PhD admission will be made in both the semesters of the year.
- 6.1.2. The URC will ascertain the number of vacancies (Supervisor wise) in different Faculty of Studies in advance based on the information received from different Faculty of Studies, so that the notification for AdtU-RET can be issued.
- 6.1.3. URC decides the date of holding AdtU-RET examination.
- 6.1.4. Registrar issues the notification for AdtU-RET examination through advertisement in national and regional newspapers and the University website.
- 6.1.5. CoE then shall conduct the AdtU-RET examination and declare the results.
- 6.1.6. The AdtU-RET examination has the following two components:
 - a) Written test
 - b) Interview/Personal interaction
- 6.1.7. Written test: The written examination comprises sixty (60) marks. Table 2 below shows the details of the written examination along with allocations of marks for the written examination:

Table 2: Components of PhD -RET & Mark distribution

Sl. No	Name of the subcomponents	Marks
(i)	Subject Specific Questions	Twenty (20)
(ii)	Basics of Computer	Forty (40)
(iii)	Basics of English Language	
(iv)	Basics of Research Methodology	
Note: MCQ type questions will be set for all the above four subcomponents.		

- 6.1.8. A committee will be constituted for moderation of AdtU-RET question paper for PhD entrance written test. The Dean of Studies, AdtU will be the Chairperson of the committee. All the Deans of different Faculties of AdtU will be the members of the committee for moderation of the Question Paper.
- 6.1.9. The assessment through personal interaction will be based on 40 marks. The interaction will be conducted by the concerned FRC based on the candidate's application. The interaction will include a mandatory presentation by the candidate on a tentative research topic/idea of his/her chosen field. The FRC of the concerned faculty conducting the interaction of the candidates for admission into the Ph. D programme shall also be responsible for allocation of the Supervisors to the students on the basis of available seats within the limit of number of PhD research scholars under the eligible faculty member.
- 6.1.10. The combined pass mark for the two components, i.e., written test and personal interaction together are fifty (50) out of the total marks of one hundred (100), subject to condition that the candidate secured more than 50% marks in the personal interaction segment for consideration of selection.
- 6.1.11. Appropriate measures shall be taken to maintain confidentiality of the test all through out the process.
- 6.2. **Exemption from Entrance test:** The candidates who have qualified UGC/CSIR-NET/(JRF) including SLET/SET or passed M.Phil. Degrees (through regular mode only) in the concerned subject are exempted from the written examination of AdtU-RET. However, they shall have to appear in counseling for getting admission into the programme.
- 6.3. **Declaration of results of AdtU RET:** While declaring the result of AdtU-RET, the CoE shall consider the followings:
- 6.3.1. Eligibility criteria of combined marks of AdtU-RET and interview.
- 6.3.2. The number of qualified candidates in the merit list should tally with the number of vacancies in the department/ discipline of the respective FRC.
- 6.3.3. Other qualified candidates will be declared as waitlisted candidates discipline wise under the FRC.
- 6.3.4. The AdtU-RET result should also display the names of Supervisors along with the departments against the merit listed candidates.

7. RECOGNITION &ALLOCATION OF RESEARCH SUPERVISOR:

7.1. Eligibility criteria of PhD Supervisor for Faculty of Paramedical Science and Faculty of Nursing are as follows:

7.1.1. Any regular Professor having 2 (two) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed/UGC CARE/MCI indexed listed journals with atleast1 (one) publication during the last 5 (five) years, shall be eligible.

7.1.2. Any regular Associate Professor/Assistant Professor with PhD degree and 2 (two) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed/ UGC CARE/ MCI indexed listed journals with atleast 1 (one) publication during the last 5 (five) years and with at least one year post-PhD teaching/research/industrial experience, shall be eligible.

7.2. Eligibility criteria of PhD Supervisor for Faculty of Pharmaceutical Science, Faculty of Science, Faculty of Engineering & Technology, Faculty of Humanities and Social Science, Faculty of Commerce & Management is as follows:

7.2.1. Any regular Professor having 4 (four) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed / UGC CARE listed journals with atleast3 (three) publications during the last 5 (five) years, shall be eligible.

7.2.2. Any regular Associate Professor/Assistant Professor with PhD degree and 4 (four) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed / UGC CARE listed journals with atleast3 (three) publications during the last 5 (five) years, and with at least one year of post-PhD teaching/research/industrial experience, shall be eligible.

7.2.3. Applicants as mentioned in clause no 1.2.1 & 1.2.2 having at least 2 (two) research papers published in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed/UGC CARE indexed listed journals out of which at least 1 (one) published during the last five years will be eligible provided he/she has adequate number of other technical/scientific/research publications to compensate the deficiency as per the weightage given in the Table 3 below.

Table 3: Weightage of other Technical/Scientific/ Research Publications

Sl No	Technical/Scientific/ Research Publications	Equivalent to research paper
1	Each Book authored / edited which are published by International/ National Publisher	1 paper
2	Each Chapter in Edited Book	0.5 paper
3	One full paper in international / national conference proceedings conducted by recognized academic / professional bodies/society	0.5 paper
At least one publication of above category must be during the last 5 (five) years.		

- 7.3. Only a full time regular teacher of the University can act as a Supervisor of a Ph. D student.
- 7.4. A research Supervisor who is a Professor, cannot guide more than eight (8) PhD scholars, at any given point of time. An Associate Professor can guide up to a maximum of six (6) PhD scholars at any given point of time and an Assistant Professor can guide up to a maximum of four (4) PhD scholars at any given point of time.
- 7.5. The allocation of a research Supervisor for a selected research scholar shall be decided by the FRC concerned subject to availability of vacancy with the research Supervisor, the available specialization among the Supervisors and research interests of scholars.
- 7.6. In case of topics that are inter-disciplinary/multidisciplinary in nature if FRC feels that the department expertise has to be supplemented from outside, another Supervisor fulfilling all the eligibility requirements as above (Clause Nos. 7.1 to 7.5 as the case may be) in addition to the Supervisor from the parent department, may be appointed.
- 7.7. In case of relocation of a woman PhD scholar due to marriage or otherwise, the research data shall be allowed to be transferred to the University to which the scholar intends to relocate provided all the other conditions in these regulations are followed in letter and spirit and the research work does not pertain to the project secured by the parent institutions/Supervisor from any funding agency. The scholar will, however, give due credit to the original Supervisor and the University for the part of research already done.

8. ADMISSION TO PhD PROGRAMME

- 8.1. After the declaration of AdtU-RET result, the same will be published and notified by CoE along with an official communication to PhD admission office.
- 8.2. The PhD Admission Cell will communicate about selection to the successful candidates and send the 'Form for PhD admission' to be filled in and submitted along with the check list of required documents to be submitted by the candidates along with the duly filled in form for admission into the PhD programme of AdtU. .
- 8.3. The eligible candidates who have cleared the AdtU-RET shall apply, within the stipulated time as specified in the activity chart of PhD programme for admission to the PhD programme.
- 8.4. The PhD admission office will verify the following documents of the candidates:
 - (i). Original mark sheets/certificates/testimonials from HSLC onwards
 - (ii). Caste certificate/Differently able certificate as the case may be.
 - (iii). No Objection Certificate from the employer (if the candidate is employed).
 - (iv). Address and identity proof such as Aadhaar Card / Voter ID / Passport / PRC etc.
 - (v). In case of foreign students (Additional documents required):
 - a) Relevant pages in the passport, if it contains a visa for pursuing higher education/ Research in India. If, no such visa for pursuing higher education is stamped in the passport, a NOC from the Embassy/High Commissioner of India in the country of origin of the research scholar.
 - b) NOC from the Embassy/High Commissioner of the country of origin of the research scholar, in India
- 8.5. Following document verification and payment of fees, the selected candidates will be admitted to the University for PhD programme. All the information and files generated for the PhD admission of the candidates will be communicated by the Admission office to URC and respective FRC. The admitted PhD scholars will be allowed to register in the mandatory course work.
- 8.6. In case, any selected candidate fails to take admission in the stipulated time, the seat shall be forfeited and the same shall be offered to the next candidate next in the waiting list.

9. COURSE WORK

- 9.1. Immediately after admission, all the PhD research scholars shall register into the PhD Course work by filling in the requisite Proforma.
- 9.2. The admitted PhD students shall have to undergo one semester mandatory Pre-Registration Course Work of six months duration on four subject fields(refer to clause 9.3 and Table no 3). At the end of the course work, each student has to appear in Pre-Registration Course Work Examination.
- 9.3. **Course structure of the PhD Course Work:** All PhD students should undertake four Courses (Table 4). Course I, Course II and Course IV are common to all candidates irrespective of the discipline/department, while Course III is discipline/department specific and/or research topic specific.
- 9.4. **Course-III in the course work may have the following two components:**
 - 9.4.1. First component: It is comprised of the candidate's research topic related literature survey. This component may comprise of a minimum of 30% content of the course, or it may comprise of 100% of this Course-III at maximum.
 - 9.4.2. Second Component: Wherever this component of Course III is relevant for the PhD research scholar it comprises of 70% of the Course III. This component is included as part of course III for imparting knowledge and practice on certain specialized instruments and/or imparting some specified information for carrying out the proposed research work of research scholars in some departments/faculties. As specified in component one, the course III where there is no such requirement of research related topics, the course III will allot 100% of the time and credit for Literature Survey work when the research topic of PhD research does not involve any training/practice for specific research equipment.

It will be in discretion of the FRC to decide the component one and component two of Course III on case to case basis.
- 9.5. Evaluation of each of the courses except Course III shall be based on 100 marks, of which 40% will be taken for continual Internal Assessment and the rest 60% marks will be for written examination at the semester end. The written component of Course III will be 60% marks, and will be evaluated on the basis of quality of the literature survey and oral examination report, oral examination and a PPT presentation before the FRC.

Table 4:Course structure of the PhD Course Work

Course no.	Name of the course	Mode	No. of hours (hrs)/week	Credit points
Course-I	Research Methodology	Common to all disciplines/departments	2 hrs (Theory)	2
Course-II	Statistical Methods & Computer Application	Common to all disciplines/departments	2 hrs (Theory)	2
Course-III	Literature Survey (30% / 100% of course-III)	Research Topic Related	2hrs * 6 hrs **	3
	Departmental Topics (Optional) (0% / 70% of Course-III)	Discipline Specific and/or research topic specific	4hr *** 0 hr ****	
Course-IV	Research Publication Ethics	Common to all disciplines/departments	2 (Theory)	2
Total			12	9
Note: *2hrs of Library Work/week, if the Literature Survey component forms 30% of Course-III. In such a case, there will be a departmental topic (optional) component forming 70% of Course-III. ** 6 hrs of Library Work/week, if the Literature Survey component forms 100% of Course-III. In such a case, the optional component of Course-III will not be there. *** 4hr of Theory/week, if the departmental topic (optional) component comprising 70% of Course-III is there besides the Literature Survey component forming 30% of Course-III. **** 0 hr of theory/week, if the departmental topic (optional) component forms 0% of Course-III. In other words, there will be no optional component and the Literature Survey component forms the entire 100% of Course-III				

9.6. The internal assessment of each course has two parts:

- 9.6.1. Part-1 (Continuous assessment) will comprise of 50% internal assessment and will include attendance in coursework class, score in assignments and presentation and overall impression of FRC on a scholar's progress. The breakup of the 50% marks for various parts will be as per AdtU norms).
- 9.6.2. Part-2 (Sessional examination) will comprise of 50% internal assessment and will include two sessional examinations of each of one hour duration and of ten (10) marks.

- 9.7. **Scheme for internal assessments and semester end examination:** The Scheme for internal assessments and the semester end examination is given in Table 4.

Table 5: Scheme for internal assessments and end semester examination

Course no.	Name of the course	Internal assessment			Semester End Examination		Grand total marks	
		Part -1: Continuous mode	Part – 2: Sessional exams		Total	Marks		Duration
			Marks	Duration				
Course-I	Research Methodology	20	10+10	1 hr.	40	60	2 hrs.	100
Course-II	Statistical Analysis & Computer Application	20	10 +10	1 hr.	40	60	2 hrs.	100
Course-III	Literature Survey and Departmental Topics (Optional)	20	20*	---	40	60**	---	100
Course-IV	Research Publication Ethics	20	10+10	1 hr.	40	60	2 hrs.	100
Total		80	80		160	240		400
Note: * indicates that the sessional examination part of the internal assessment of Course-III carrying twenty (20) marks. This will also be on the basis of assignment/ presentation arranged by the FRC before the respective department. ** indicates that the semester end evaluation/assessment for this Course-III carrying sixty (60) marks will be on the basis of a report submission and/or viva-voce with a PPT presentation before the FRC.								

- 9.8. **Minimum eligibility requirement of class attendance for appearing in coursework examination:** Failing to attend at least 75% of classes in the courses will debar the scholar from appearing in the semester end course work examination. Such students may join in the course work of the next semester to continue their PhD programme.
- 9.9. **Grading of performance:** In calculation of marks for deciding on the grade in a course, the combined marks secured in both the components (i.e. internal assessment and semester end examination) shall be considered. The different percentage of marks and corresponding grade score are presented in Table 6. A candidate must secure a minimum of letter grade 'D' and corresponding Numeric Grade 6 to pass the Pre-Registration Course Work Examination in a course.

Table 6: Grading of proformances

% of marks obtained	Letter Grade	Numeric Grade	Proformance
90 – 100	O	10	Outstanding
80 – 89.9	A	9	Excellent
70 – 79.9	B	8	Good
60 – 69.9	C	7	Fair
50 – 59.9	D	6	Average
Less than 50	F	0	Fail
Absent	AB	0	Fail

- 9.10. **The Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA):** The proformance of a PhD scholar in the course work will be indicated by a parameter called SGPA. The SGPA is the weighted average of the grade points obtained in all the courses by the scholar during the semester. For example, if a scholar takes four courses in a semester with credits C₁, C₂, C₃ and C₄ and the scholar's numeric grades in these courses are G₁, G₂, G₃ and G₄, respectively, then scholar's SGPA will be equal to:

$$SGPA = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^4 C_i G_i}{\sum_{i=1}^4 C_i} = \frac{C_1 G_1 + C_2 G_2 + C_3 G_3 + C_4 G_4}{C_1 + C_2 + C_3 + C_4}$$

- 9.11. Failed/unsuccessful candidates may apply for re-evaluation/rechecking of their answer script as per AdtU examination norms.
- 9.12. Every PhD research scholar shall be given a maximum of two chances to appear examination of each course and to clear course work successfully (including the first regular examination). If a srtudent fails to appear in an examination after completion of course work, it will deem as loosing a chance and he/she will be left with only one chance to clear examination (s)of course/courses.
- 9.13. The candidates who can not clear the examination in the first chance, shall have to pass the same in the second (last chance), examination which shall be held within one month from the date of declaration of results of first regular examination.
- 9.14. A candidate will need to appear only in the failed course(s) in the second chance (repeat examination) to clear a course.

10. REGISTRATION:

- 10.1. A candidate after passing course work examination successfully will be eligible for submission of research synopsis and proceed for registration.
- 10.2. Once the Supervisor is allocated to the research scholar, the process of finalization of research area/topic/title should be initiated and preparation of the synopsis should be completed within 2nd semester.
- 10.3. A synopsis of the proposed research work shall be submitted to the concerned FRC in triplicate, within a period of one month from the date of publication of result of the course work examination.
- 10.4. After receipt of synopsis, FRC should seek the opinion of an external expert from a similar field of work/subject/discipline or who is familiar to the scholar's research area.
- 10.5. After receipt of opinion from the external expert, FRC will take final decision in relation to incorporation of the suggestions of external expert and may ask the candidate to revise the synopsis if required or may allow the candidate to present his/her seminar after receipt of following documents-
 - (i). Supervisor(s) Declaration Form
 - (ii). Proforma for Synopsis Submission
 - (iii). Course Work Mark sheet
 - (iv). Copy of the receipt of payment of registration fee in full
- 10.6. The scholar shall give a power point presentation before the FRC on the synopsis which is also called PhD Registration Seminar. If there is any observation/comment/suggestion/modification made by the FRC, the scholar will have to resubmit three (3) copies of his/her revised synopsis to the FRC incorporating the suggestion/modification etc. made by the FRC within a period of one month from the day of presentation.
- 10.7. The PhD research scholars will be able to avail 3 attempts to present his/her PhD research synopsis to the satisfaction and acceptance by FRC and failing to clear the registration seminar even on third attempt, within six months after the completion of course work may lead to cancellation of his/her admission.
- 10.8. Allotment of another Supervisor from collaborating university/institute/approved research centre may be allowed after recommendation of respective FRC in the case of PhD researches that are multi-disciplinary/inter-disciplinary in nature. Only a full time regular

teacher of the University/collaborating institute/approved research centre fulfilling the requirements as mentioned under clause Nos. 7.1 to 7.5 above shall be eligible to act as Supervisor with the approval of URC. However, the Supervisor allotted from AdtU shall be responsible to look after and coordinate supervision, monitoring and progress of the entire research work of the PhD scholar and will chair all the meetings and discussions related to the research scholar's work.

- 10.9. FRC then will forward its recommendations regarding the registration of the scholar to the URC.
- 10.10. In this stage, Major Supervisor of the scholar from AdtU will propose an Advisory Committee through FRC. URC will approve the formation of Advisory committee.
- 10.11. The Advisory committee of each scholar will comprise of
 - (i). Major Supervisor (from the department/discipline of the scholar in which the degree programme is sought)
 - (ii). Another faculty member (recognized PhD supervisor of AdtU) from the same department/discipline of the faculty
 - (iii). A faculty member (recognized PhD supervisor of AdtU) from any department/discipline/faculty related to the scholar's research works
 - (iv). The designated Supervisor from outside the university, if any
- 10.12. The major supervisor shall be the chairperson of the Advisory committee. In case the major supervisor leaves the university and there is necessity to appoint major supervisor (as per clause no 32 of the PhD Regulations, 2021) the second member of the committee will be the major supervisor and Chairman subject to fulfillment of the clause No. 7.4 of the PhD Regulations, 2021. In a situation when the second member does not fulfill the criteria then another faculty member fulfilling the criteria will be allotted as the major supervisor on the basis of recommendation made by the FRC of the concerned faculty.
- 10.13. URC at this stage, will ratify the recommendation granting registration. Member Secretary, URC will forward the decision of the URC granting registration of the PhD scholar to the Registrar(Academic) /Deputy Registrar (Academic) to initiate the process of notification.
- 10.14. The Registrar(Academic) /Deputy Registrar (Academic) will issue a notification asking the scholar to submit the application for registration in the prescribed format after payment of necessary fees.

10.15. The scholar will fill the prescribed registration form along with the following documents:

- i. The letter from the Registrar (Academic)/Deputy Registrar (Academic) permitting him/her to apply for registration (self-attested copy).
- ii. Registration fee payment receipt (self-attested copy).
- iii. NOC for fee payment (self-attested copy).
- iv. Pan Card (in case of Indian National) (self-attested copy).
- v. In case of foreign students (Additional documents required):
 - a. Relevant pages in the passport, if it contains a visa for pursuing higher education /research in India. If, no such visa for pursuing higher education is stamped in the passport, a NOC from the Embassy/High Commissioner of India in the country of origin of the research scholar.
 - b. NOC from the Embassy/High Commissioner of the country of origin of the research scholar, in India

10.16. On completion of the above procedure, the Registrar (Academic)/Deputy Registrar (Academic) will issues a registration certificate (in a prescribed format) stating the date of effect of registration. Usually, the date of effect of registration should be the date of recommendation of registration by the concerned FRC.

10.17. It should however be noted that the entire process of issue of registration certificate should be completed within a period of two (2) months from the date of recommendation by the FRC for registration.

10.18. The candidate will complete the process of registration within the stipulated time period as mention above. Candidates who are unable to register within the period of six months from the date of announcement of results of course work, may be allowed to do so only after their authorized leave of absence but not later than one year from the announcement of the results of course work. Registration of such candidates will be processed with the PhD research scholars of subsequent batch only.

11. SIX MONTHLY PROGRESS REPORT OF RESEARCH WORK:

11.1. The research scholar will submit a progress report of his/her PhD research work to the concerned FRC every six month, within the stipulated period as ear marked in the time of preparation of activity chart to the concerned FRC, followed by a power point presentation on the progress report before the concerned FRC. The FRC will evaluate and provide further guidance.

- 11.2. The scholar will incorporate the suggestions/modifications (if any) suggested by the FRC into the progress report and will submit a revised progress report in triplicate to the FRC, duly certified by the Supervisor to the effect that the modifications/suggestions have been incorporated. In case, there is suggestion for repeating some experiments for appropriate modification of the progress report, the revised progress report may be submitted along with next progress report.
- 11.3. The FRC will forward the six monthly progress reports to the URC.
- 11.4. A minimum of five half yearly PhD research work progress reports of the scholar, which are duly approved by the FRC, is a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission of one PhD scholar thesis.
- 11.5. In case, the progress of the research scholar is unsatisfactory, the FRC shall record the reasons for the same and suggest corrective measures. If the research scholar fails to implement these corrective measures, the FRC may then recommend to the URC with specific reasons for cancellation of the registration of the research scholar keeping in mind the maximum permissible duration of the PhD programme.
- 11.6. In case of inability of the scholar to submit a six monthly progress report and to make subsequent power point presentation, he/she may be permitted for an extension of a period of maximum six months to submit the pending progress report and presentation. However, the scholar would be allowed to avail this facility only once during his/her entire research tenure.
- 11.7. After availing the concession accorded in clause 11.6, above, any subsequent non-submission of progress report within the prescribed date as earmarked at the time of preparation of activity chart of PhD programme, will be viewed with concern and such lapse may lead to cancellation of his/her registration.

12. MODIFICATION OF THESIS TITLE:

- 12.1. On recommendation of the Supervisor, a candidate may be allowed to apply to the Chairperson (Executive) of the concerned FRC for modification of the title of the thesis, only once.
- 12.2. The FRC after examining the proposed modification shall send the recommendation to the URC;

12.2.1. It must be noted that such modification of title must not alter the basic essence or contents of the research work.

12.2.2. No modification/alteration of the research title is permissible after the approval of the report of the pre-submission thesis seminar by URC.

13. PhD THROUGH DISTANCE MODE/PART-TIME BASIS:

13.1. There will be no PhD programme offered through distance education mode under AdtU.

13.2. Part-time PhD will be allowed provided all the relevant conditions mentioned in different clauses under this regulation including the minimum residency/contact period (As per Clause No. 14) are fulfilled.

14. MINIMUM RESIDENCY/CONTACT PERIOD:

14.1. Minimum residency/contact period requirement of a part-time PhD scholar in AdtU will be 150 working days excluding the course work period.

14.2. Attendance records of such scholars will be maintained by the respective Supervisors/member secretaries of FRCs and a report of the attendance will be sent to the office of the Vice Chancellor on monthly basis. The concerned FRC will report the matter to URC if a part-time scholar fails to attain the required attendance.

14.3. The residency/contact period requirement ensures that the research scholars spend certain minimum time in the university utilising the physical infrastructure like laboratories, libraries etc. and having personal contact with their Supervisors.

14.4. However, for research programme under disciplines such as Humanities and Management, Social Work etc., field work undertaken in pursuit of his/her research work with the consent/permission of research Supervisor may be considered towards residency/contact period requirement of AdtU of a part-time research scholar. However, such period must not exceed one-third of the minimum residency/contact period requirement.

15. PUBLICATION CLAUSE:

- 15.1. The FRC should ensure that the candidate fulfils the publication clauses before recommending submission of the abstract and the thesis.
- 15.2. The publications should contain names of the authors including the Supervisor(s) in addition to the PhD scholar's own name as the first author. The Supervisor of the PhD scholar from the university should preferably be the corresponding author in the publications made out of the research work.
- 15.3. The affiliation of all the authors must be shown in the publications and mention of @adtu in email.
- 15.4. The publication(s) is/are within the period of the scholar's PhD research in the University.
- 15.5. Publications should be related to PhD work of candidate.
- 15.6. The publication(s) is/are in the UGC-CARE listed journals.
- 15.7. The required number of publications and number of conferences /seminars attended (As per clause Nos. 17.2 and 17.3).
- 15.8. The reprint of each of listed article(s) published (or acceptance letter(s) of the articles, if not already published) should be attached.

16. CLEARANCE OF ETHICS COMMITTEE:

- 16.1. All the scholars must obtain the clearance from AdtU Ethics Committee wherever applicable, in relation to his/her work.
- 16.2. Scholars must obtain the clearance from Institutional Animal Ethics Committee (IAEC) in relation to his/her work, if applicable.

17. ACADEMIC PRE-REQUISITE FOR PRE-SUBMISSION PRESENTATION:

- 17.1. A minimum of five consecutive half yearly progress reports of the scholar, all duly approved by the FRC, will be a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission presentation of his/her thesis.
- 17.2. Every scholar has to publish at least one Research Paper on his/her research work in a UGC-CARE listed journal before the pre-submission presentation and produce evidence to that affect, in the form of a reprint or acceptance letter. However, for those disciplines which do not have any UGC-CARE listed journal, the concerned Department/FRC will prepare a list of journals and submit it through the concerned FRC to the URC for approval.
- 17.3. Every research scholar must make two paper presentations in conferences/seminars (national/international), before the pre-submission presentation, and produce evidence for the same in the form of certificates and/or reprints.
- 17.4. Part Time scholars should complete residency period as per Clause no. 14.
- 17.5. Certificate from Institutional Animal Ethics Committee (IAEC) in relation to his/her work, if applicable, must be produced.
- 17.6. Approval from AdtU Ethics Committee in relation to his/her work.
- 17.7. Scholar must clear all his/her dues to be able to make the pre-submission presentation.

18. PRE-SUBMISSION PRESENTATION:

- 18.1. Prior to submission of Abstract and the thesis, a scholar has to give pre-submission presentation on his/her entire work highlighting the findings (chapter wise), in presence of the concerned FRC. The presence of Supervisor(s) is mandatory in the presentation.
- 18.2. After fulfillment of the pre-requisites for pre-submission seminar (Clause no 17), scholar must apply for pre-submission seminar to the respective FRC submitting the following documents:

- a) Application for pre-submission seminar in AdtU format.
 - b) Three copies of detailed abstract of the work completed by scholar and duly signed by the supervisor(s).
 - c) Re-print of thesis research paper publications/Acceptance letter from the concerned Journal.
 - d) Copy of presentation in Conference/Seminar
- 18.3. Respective FRC will thoroughly check the content and quality of PhD work and ensure fulfillment of the pre-requisites for pre-submission seminar. FRC shall allow the candidate to present the pre-submission seminar only if the FRC is satisfied with the progress of work.
- 18.4. The respective FRC may invite an external expert in the pre submission seminar from the similar field of work/subject/discipline or who is familiar to the scholar research area.
- 18.5. FRC may recommend further necessary action if the pre-submission seminar has been found satisfactory or may ask the scholar to incorporate the suggestions of FRC and present the seminar again.
- 18.6. On satisfactory proformance in the presentation, the Chairperson (Executive) of the concerned FRC shall recommend that the scholar may be allowed to submit the abstract and the thesis to the URC.
- 18.7. On recommendation from the FRC, the URC may permit a candidate to submit the abstract and the thesis subject to the fulfillment of the conditions as mentioned in the various provisions of this regulation.
- 18.8. After recommendation of URC, Registrar (Academic) /Deputy Registrar (Academic) shall issue a letter (in a prescribed format) stating that scholar can go for anti-plagiarism check and should submit the abstract and thesis within 3 months from the date of issuing the letter. However, the scholar can apply for an extension of time for rewriting of the thesis and submit keeping in mind the maximum permissible period of time for completion of the degree programme.
- 18.9. If a research scholar fails to submit the thesis in stipulated/permitted time period while fulfilling the clause nos. 18.3, 18.4 and 18.5 above, the URC may consider granting relaxation of thesis submission date as recommended by the FRC after the pre-submission seminar is presented afresh

19. LANGUAGE OF THESIS:

The thesis shall be written in English.

20. ANTI-PLAGIARISM CHECK:

- 20.1. Thesis evaluation by anti-plagiarism software (i.e. Urkund) in AdtU is mandatory by paying requisite fees. The maximum acceptable limit of plagiarism is 10% in accordance to the current UGC guidelines.
- 20.2. The process of plagiarism check during the submission of thesis is mentioned in Clause no. 21.

21. SUBMISSION OF ABSTRACT AND THESIS:

- 21.1. After receiving letter from Registrar (Academic) /Deputy Registrar (Academic) as mentioned in Clause no 18.4, the PhD research scholar can submit the thesis for plagiarism check within stipulated time.
- 21.2. Candidate should prepare the thesis as per AdtU thesis writing guidelines given in the Annexure-I and same has to be verified by the concerned Supervisor(s) and FRC before submission of thesis to PhD Cell.
- 21.3. **Thesis submission & request for plagiarism check:** Initially the candidate must submit following documents:
 - (i). Application for thesis submission and plagiarism check
 - (ii). One (01) copy of PhD thesis (soft binding)
 - (iii). Soft copy of PhD thesis
 - (iv). Copy of letter from Registrar (Academic)/ Deputy Registrar (Academic) regarding thesis submission
 - (v). Thesis Review Report from Supervisors (Original)
 - (vi). Thesis Review Report for Concern FRC(Original)
 - (vii). Copy of Residency period certificate from Supervisor(s)
 - (viii). List of publications, seminar / conference presentations
 - (ix). Confidentiality and copyright statement as mentioned in clause no 30 of AdtU PhD Regulation.
 - (x). NOC on Payment of fees.
 - (xi). Fee payment receipt for plagiarism check

- 21.4. The Supervisor of the scholar must submit a panel of not less than seven experts in the specified format with full address, designation, area of specialization, academic and research experience, phone no, email ids etc. in a sealed envelope as a confidential document to the PhD Cell.
- 21.5. Upon receipt of above mentioned documents and thesis, PhD cell shall forward the soft copy of thesis to the Librarian of the university for plagiarism check.
- 21.6. If the thesis passes the similarity index check, the Librarian shall issue a certificate in prescribed format. The candidate then needs to submit the application for thesis submission (in prescribed format) along with the remaining four (04) copies PhD thesis (soft binding) after incorporating the plagiarism check report, along with five (05) copies of Abstract.
- 21.7. If the thesis fails to pass the similarity index check, candidate will be asked to revise the thesis as per 'UGC regulation on Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions 2018'. In such case, plagiarism check of the thesis will be carried out after submission of revised thesis as mentioned in clause no 21.3 to 21.6.

22. APPOINTMENT OF EXAMINERS AND RECEIPT OF REPORTS:

- 22.1. On receipt of the abstract, thesis along with other necessary documents (as mentioned in Clause no 22.3), the PhD Cell will forward the same to CoE.
- 22.2. The CoE shall place the panel of examiners before the Vice Chancellor for appointment of two examiners out of the panel of experts, besides the Supervisor(s).
- 22.3. On receiving the consent from the examiners, the CoE shall send a copy of the thesis to each of the examiners for evaluation.
- 22.4. The CoE will receive the reports from the External Examiners and Supervisor(s) in sealed envelopes and will place those before the Vice Chancellor in sealed condition. The reports of the external examiners will be communicated to the Supervisor by CoE. In case, the report(s) from the external examiner(s) contain any suggestion for alteration/modification, the concerned Supervisor will take steps for the scholar to affect those changes.
- 22.5. The candidate will incorporate the suggestions/modifications made by the external examiners in consultation with the Supervisor(s) and submit the revised thesis containing a certificate from the Supervisor(s), in the body of the revised thesis, that the

suggestions/modifications put forward by the external examiners have been duly incorporated.

- 22.6. As per the direction of the Vice Chancellor, the CoE will then initiate the viva-voce process.
- 22.7. In case, there were no suggestions/modifications suggested, the CoE, at the direction of the Vice Chancellor, will initiate the viva-voce process.
- 22.8. The entire process of evaluation of the PhD thesis up to receipt of the report from the Board of Examiners of viva-voce on the day of Final viva-voce, shall preferably be completed within a period of six months from the date of submission of the abstract and the thesis.

23. EXAMINATION OF THESIS:

The thesis shall be examined in two stages:

- 23.1. **First Stage: Evaluation by the Examiners:** The examiners will submit reports in the format supplied with any of the following options:

- 23.1.1. **The thesis be accepted as it is:** The examiners may give a detailed report in a separate sheet (if necessary), in addition to the comments in the format supplied.

- 23.1.2. **The thesis be accepted after minor corrections and modifications as suggested:** The examiners will indicate the minor corrections and the modifications required. In this case, the examiners will also state whether the thesis is worthy of publication. The thesis may be accepted after the candidate incorporates those suggestion/modifications in the thesis and the Supervisor certifies to that effect.

- 23.1.3. **The Thesis be Revised and resubmitted:** The examiners will indicate the type and nature of revision to be done by the Scholar. For such revision, the candidate shall be provided with the report(s) of the Examiner(s) who has/have suggested the revision.

- 23.1.4. **The thesis be rejected.**

- 23.1.4.1. In this case, if one of the external examiners recommends rejection citing valid reasons for such rejection, the thesis shall be referred to a third external examiner from the panel of examiners. If the report of the third external examiner is satisfactory, the CoE will then initiate the process of viva-voce. If the report of the third external examiner is also unsatisfactory, the thesis shall be rejected and the research scholar shall be declared ineligible for award of the degree.

- 23.1.4.2. If reports of both the external examiners are unsatisfactory then the thesis shall be rejected and the research scholar shall be declared ineligible for award of the degree.
- 23.2. **Second Stage: On satisfactory recommendations from two external examiners, the viva-voce will be arranged as follows:**
- The public viva-voce of the research scholar to defend the thesis shall be conducted only if the evaluation reports of two external examiners on the thesis are satisfactory and include a specific recommendation for conducting the viva-voce examination. An Executive Summary of the thesis (not more than 5 pages) is to be submitted by the candidate to the Board of Examiners of viva-voce.
- 23.3. **Board of Examiners of viva-voce:**The Board of Examiners to conduct viva-voce shall consist of:
- (i). The Chairperson (Executive) of the concerned FRC/ Dean of the concerned Faculty of Study - Chairperson of the Board of Examiners
 - (ii). Dean of Studies, AdtU - Member
 - (iii). The Chairperson (Advisor) of the concerned FRC - Member
 - (iv). Associate Dean/HoD/Programme coordinator/Senior Faculty member (not below the rank of Associate Professor) of the concerned department – Member
 - (v). The Supervisor(s) of the Scholar – Member
 - (vi). One External Examiner of the thesis out of two, to be chosen by the Chairperson, URC - External Expert member
- In case the Dean/Chairperson, FRC happens to be the Supervisor of the candidate, the Vice Chancellor shall nominate a Professor of the concerned/allied Department as a member of the Board of Examiners of viva-voce.
- 23.4. The report will be written and signed only by the members of the Board of Examiners of viva-voce. However, the viva-voce will be open i.e.; all faculty members and other research scholars of the concerned/other department may attend the viva-voce of the scholar.
- 23.5. The report of the Board of Examiners of viva-voce along with the executive summary submitted by the scholar shall be forwarded by the Chairperson, FRC in a sealed envelope to the CoE who shall then present the report in before the Board of Management of Assam down town University for the approval of the award of Degree.

24. SUBMISSION OF HARD BOUND THESIS:

A scholar shall submit two hard bound copies of the final thesis along with two soft copies (in CD form) to the CoE after incorporating corrections/modifications etc. (if any), as suggested by the Board of Examiners of viva-voce within one month from the date of viva-voce. The Supervisor(s) and the Chairperson (Executive) of the concerned FRC have to certify in the body of the thesis that the thesis has been corrected and modified as per suggestions of the viva-voce Examination Board.

25. AWARD OF DEGREE:

The Board of Management, AdtU on recommendation of the viva-voce Examination Board shall approve the award of the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) to the eligible candidate. The CoE will then publish the result mentioning the name of the candidate, title of the thesis, name of the Supervisor(s) and the subject domain/discipline to which the thesis is related.

The degree to the successful candidates will be conferred only at the time of convocation.

26. ISSUE OF CERTIFICATE AND INFORMATION TO UGC:

- 26.1. Original certificate will be issued to the successful scholar at the time of Convocation or thereafter in absentia. A provisional degree certificate will be issued by the University until the convocation of the University is held.
- 26.2. CoE will forward one copy of the final bound volume of the thesis and soft copy of thesis to University Librarian and thesis (soft copy & hard copy) shall be preserved in the University Library.
- 26.3. CoE will forward a final soft copy of the thesis to Member Secretary, URC within a week from the date of award of Degree. A soft copy of the thesis shall be submitted to the UGC by the Member Secretary, URC within a period of one month from the date of award of Degree.

27. PAYMENT OF TUITION & OTHER FEES:

The research scholar admitted in the PhD programme shall be required to pay the admission fees and other fees as prescribed from time to time for all the terms from the admission to the date of submission of thesis.

28. DURATION OF PROGRAMME:

- 28.1. PhD . programme shall be for a minimum duration of three years, including course work and a maximum of six years for full time research scholars..
- 28.2. The maximum duration of the PhD programme for a part-time student will be seven (7) years, counted from the date of admission to the date of submission of thesis.
- 28.3. If a candidate pursuing PhD programme under either Full-Time/Part Time is unable to complete the work in the maximum prescribed period, the Vice-Chancellor may, on the recommendation of the FRC can give extension of time up to one year from the date of expiry of registration beyond which the registration of the candidate cease.
- 28.4. The women candidates and Persons with Disability (more than 40%) may be allowed a relaxation of two years for PhD in the maximum duration. In addition, the women candidates may be provided Maternity Leave/Child Care Leave once in the entire duration of M.Phil/PhD for up to 240 days.

29. CANCELLATION OF PhD ADMISSION & REGISTRATION

- 29.1. URC shall be the competent body to recommend cancellation of admission and/or registration of a research scholar in the following events:
 - 29.1.1. Unsatisfactory progress in Research as reported by Supervisor(s) through FRC.
 - 29.1.2. Voluntary withdrawal of admission.
 - 29.1.3. If candidate fails to clear Course Work Examination within two consecutive chances (as per clause no 9.11, 9.12 and 9.13).
 - 29.1.4. Non submission of PhD progress report as per the regulation mentioned in clause no. 12.5 and 12.6.
 - 29.1.5. Non-payment of fee as mention in Clause no. 28 within stipulated time as notified by University time to time
 - 29.1.6. Non-submission of thesis within the stipulated time to the University.

- 29.1.7. Discontinuation of study/Research work without intimation to the Supervisor/FRC and University.
 - 29.1.8. Non-conformity with the regulations of the programme.
 - 29.1.9. In cases where Research Scholar is found to be involved in plagiarism as per ‘UGC regulation on Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism In Higher Educational Institutions 2018’
 - 29.1.10. Involvement of the PhD scholar in academic malpractice/unlawful activity/ misconduct in any form on the part of a candidate.
- 29.2. Any candidate who could not pursue his/her PhD programme due to the reasons barring clause nos. 29.1.9, and 29.1.10 as mentioned above apply afresh to continue his/her PhD programme in the university can be readmitted if recommended by the concerned FRC on payment of requisite fee as prescribed by the University. URC will take final decision in such cases.

30. CONFIDENTIALITY AND COPYRIGHT OF THE THESIS:

- 30.1. The confidentiality of the content of the thesis shall lie with the University.
- 30.2. The copyright of the thesis shall lie with the concerned PhD holder as per the copyright Act. 1968.
- 30.3. Upon submission of the thesis, candidates shall be asked to sign the following statement, enabling the University to allow others to read the University copy of the thesis, and use it for research or private study:

“I agree that my PhD thesis titled (title) will be lodged in the University Library and made available (if applicable after expiry of any period of approved restricted access) to any person(s) entitled to use the library and may be photocopied or microfilmed by or on behalf of the Librarian for use for research or private study pursuant to the provisions of the Copyright Act 1968. I agree that any user of the library may quote extracts from the thesis in any paper or written work prepared by the use, subject to acknowledging the source of the quotation.”

- 30.4. Should the author of the thesis or the Supervisor(s) wish to publish the matter in the form of a book, the author and the Supervisor(s) shall obtain clearance from the University.

31. APPROVED CENTRE FOR CARRYING OUT PART OF PhD WORK:

31.1. For the part-time PhD scholars, the institutions in which they are working may be recognized as an Approved Research Center of AdtU subject to the following conditions:

31.1.1. Such institutions must be equipped with all the basic and advanced infrastructures in accordance to the scope and requirements of the PhD work intended to be carried out there;

31.1.2. The URC shall cause an inspection of the institution for verification of the facilities. The inspection team shall put up the inspection report in the prescribed format for consideration before the URC. A certificate of approval may be issued by the URC with a copy to the respective FRC after confirming sufficient infrastructural facilities for carrying out the proposed PhD work. Such activities should be completed before allowing the candidate for registration.

31.1.3. However, renowned research/educational institutions like IITs, IISc, IIMs, University departments or research organizations of state & central Govt., at the discretion of URC, may be exempted from inspection by AdtU inspection team for granting approval.

31.1.4. A Supervisor from the same institute/near the institute where the part-time scholar is employed may be appointed provided the Supervisor fulfills the eligibility of Supervisor norms of AdtU and belongs to the similar field of research/specialization.

31.1.5. The Supervisor will authenticate in the prescribed format, the work carried out in the approved research centre in the six-monthly progress report.

31.1.6. URC of AdtU shall have the right to withdraw such recognitions of an institute as Approved Research Centers of AdtU for non-fulfillment of the requirements.

32. CHANGE OF SUPERVISOR:

32.1.1. In case, the Supervisor of a PhD scholar leaves the University or goes on lien after pre-submission seminar/ presentation, the URC may allow the concerned Supervisor to continue to complete the necessary part of the programme.

- 32.1.2. In case, the Supervisor of a PhD scholar leaves the University or goes on lien before pre submission seminar/presentation, and FRC feels that the majority of PhD work of the scholar is still pending in terms of completion of study objectives, incorporation of corrections/modifications recommended by FRC time to time, FRC may recommend for allocation of new major Supervisor to URC. In such case, if pervious major supervisor wants to continue as another supervisor, he/she shall have to give consent in writing to the concerned FRC for approval by FRC and finally by URC.
- 32.2. The change of Supervisor shall be permitted in exceptional cases like death, state of being incapacitated due to illness, mental disabilities, removal from the job and if, and only if the URC feels that such a change is absolutely necessary at any point of time. In such cases, the contribution of the respective former Supervisor shall be duly recognized/acknowledged.

33. SCHOLAR CHANGES THE JOB FROM THE UNIVERSITY OR FROM THE APPROVED RESEARCH CENTRE OF ADTU:

- 33.1. In such a case the PhD scholar must immediately inform the university (i.e. the Supervisor, the FRC and the URC) about such a change of place of job requesting for approval of the new institution which he/she has joined as an approved research centre of the university.
- 33.2. In such cases, the PhD scholar will be allowed to continue his/her PhD under the University provided:
- 33.2.1. The scholar was registered by then as a PhD scholar.
- 33.2.2. The new institution that the scholar joined is already an approved research centre of AdtU.
- 33.2.3. If the new institution is not an already approved research centre of the university, it should be eligible for getting approval
- 33.2.4. In such a case, the concerned FRC is to initiate action with the URC by proposing change in approved research centre.
- 33.2.5. URC must take immediate steps for getting the new institution approved or otherwise within a period of three (3) months from the date of intimation received from FRC.

34. ARRANGEMENT OF RECURRING AND NONRECURRING ARTICLES:

Departments of all the FRCs provide the necessary infrastructure facilities (nonrecurring) including basic and sophisticated instruments and equipments needed for conducting the research work. However, the recurring expenditures like costs of chemicals, solvents, reagents and any other consumables etc. are to be borne by the respective PhD scholar.

35. GRIEVANCE REDRESS SYSTEM:

- 35.1. In case of any grievance, the scholar may communicate through the ERP system of AdtU.
- 35.2. The URC of the University will deal with such cases.

Proposed Time Activity Chart for PhD Scholars

Events	Date(s)
AdtU-RET Examination	As per notification of University
Admission in PhD Programme	Within 15 days after Declaration of Result of AdtU-RET
Commencement of PhD Course work classes	Within one month of after completion of PhD admission process as notified by University time to time
Course work Examination	After completion of PhD Course work classes (6 months)
Publication of result of Course Work Examination	Within one month of completion of PhD Course work examination
	<i>Note: Every PhD research scholar shall be given a maximum of two chances to appear examination of each course and to clear course work successfully (including the first regular examination).</i>
Submission of Synopsis	Within one month after declaration of PhD Course work result
Synopsis presentations in respective FRC & Recommendation for PhD Registration	Within six months after declaration of PhD Course work result.
	<i>Note: The PhD research scholars will be able to avail 3 attempts to present his/her PhD research synopsis to the satisfaction and acceptance by FRC and failing to clear the registration seminar even on third attempt, within six months after the completion of course work may lead to cancellation of his/her admission.</i>
Submission of 1 st six monthly PhD Research Progress Report	After completion of 6 months from the date of PhD registration.
Submission of 2 nd six monthly PhD Research Progress Report	After completion of 12 months from the date of PhD registration.
Submission of 3 rd six monthly PhD Research Progress Report	After completion of 18 months from the date of PhD registration.
Submission of 4 th six monthly PhD Research Progress Report	After completion of 24 months from the date of PhD registration.
Submission of 5 th six monthly PhD Research Progress Report	After completion of 30 months from the date of PhD registration.
	<i>Note: In case of inability of the scholar to submit a six monthly progress report and to make subsequent power point presentation, he/she may be permitted for an extension of a period of maximum six months to submit the pending progress report and presentation. However, the scholar would be allowed to avail this facility only once during his/her entire research tenure.</i>
Thesis Pre-submission presentations in respective FRC	After completion of PhD research work & fulfillment of pre-requisite for pre-submission seminar
Submission of Thesis	After completion of Pre-submission presentations & successful plagiarism check
Award of Degree	The Board of Management, AdtU on recommendation of the viva-voce Examination Board shall approve the award of the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) to the eligible candidate.

List of Different Annexures

Sl No	Details	Annexure No
1	Guideline of PhD Thesis Writing	AdtU/PhD/I
2	Format of the ‘Cover page of the Thesis’	Annexure (i) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
3	Format of the ‘Title page of the Thesis’	Annexure (ii) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
4	Format of the ‘Certificate for Plagiarism Verification’	Annexure (iii) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
5	Format of the ‘Certificate of Declarations by PhD scholar’	Annexure (iv) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
6	Format of the ‘Certificate of the Research Supervisor’	Annexure (v) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
7	Format of the ‘Residency Certificate’	Annexure (vi) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
8	Format of the ‘Table of Contents’ of PhD thesis	Annexure (vii) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
9	Format of the ‘List of Tables’ of PhD thesis	Annexure (viii) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
10	Format of the ‘List of Figures’ of PhD thesis	Annexure (ix) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
11	Format of the Confidentiality and Copyright Declaration’	Annexure (x) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
12	Certificate from Supervisor & Chairman (Executive), FRC	Annexure (xi) [Guideline for PhD Thesis Writing]
13	Format for PhD synopsis submission	AdtU/PhD/A(i)
14	Format for submission of abstract for pre-submission seminar	AdtU/PhD/A(ii)

15	Application for PhD course work admission	AdtU/PhD/A2
16	Application for submission of PhD synopsis	AdtU/PhD/A3
17	Declaration form of Supervisor(s)	AdtU/PhD/A4
18	Application for registration in PhD programme	AdtU/PhD/A5
19	Proforma for six monthly progress report of PhD work	AdtU/PhD/A6
20	Application for pre-submission seminar	AdtU/PhD/A7
21	Pre-submission seminar report by supervisor(s)	AdtU/PhD/A8
22	Submission of a copy of PhD thesis & request for plagiarism check	AdtU/PhD/A9
23	Thesis review report by the supervisor(s)	AdtU/PhD/10
24	Thesis review report by FRC	AdtU/PhD/11
25	Application for submission of summery sheet & PhD thesis after plagiarism check	AdtU/PhD/12
26	Supervisor Application Form	AdtU/PhD/13
27	Application for extension	AdtU/PhD/14
28	Application for change in title	AdtU/PhD/15
29	Submission of Compliance Report	AdtU/PhD/16
30	Submission of final PhD thesis (hard bound) after viva-voce	AdtU/PhD/17
31	Performa for PhD Thesis Examiner's Report	AdtU/PhD/18



Amendments in the AdtU Ph.D. Regulations 2021

(Amendments in the AdtU Ph.D. Regulations 2021 approved in 48th meeting of URC held on 11/1/2023, The Academic Council, Assam down town University in its 45th meeting held on 25/01/2023 and The BoM, Assam down town University in its 57th meeting held on 25/01/2023 approved the Amendments in the AdtU Ph.D. Regulations 2021 and will be applicable from the PhD scholars of January 2023 Batch)

Clause No	Existing	Revised
5. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR ADMISSION TO PhD PROGRAMME	5.1. Candidates for admission to the PhD programme shall have a Master's degree from a recognized university or a professional degree declared equivalent to the Master's degree by the corresponding statutory regulatory body, with at least 55% marks in aggregate or its equivalent grade 'B' in the UGC 7-point scale (or an equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed) or an equivalent degree from a foreign educational institution accredited by an Assessment and Accreditation Agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country for the purpose of assessing, accrediting or assuring quality and standards of educational institutions. 5.2. A relaxation of 5% of marks, from 55% to 50%, or an equivalent relaxation of grade, may be allowed for those belonging to SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/differently able and other categories of candidates as per the direction of the UGC received by AdtU time to time, or for those who had obtained their Master's degree prior to 19th September, 1991. The eligibility marks of 55% (or an equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed) and the relaxation of 5% to the categories mentioned above are permissible based only on the qualifying marks without including the grace mark procedures.	5.1. Candidates for admission to the PhD programme shall completed: 5.1.1. 2-year/4-semester master's degree programme after a minimum 3-year bachelor's degree programme or qualifications declared equivalent to the master's degree by the corresponding statutory regulatory body, with at least 55% marks [50% for SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, Economically Weaker Section (EWS)] in aggregate or its equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed or equivalent qualification from a foreign educational institution accredited by an assessment and accreditation agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country to assess, accredit or assure quality and standards of the educational institution. 5.2.2. A 1-year/2-semester master's degree programme after a 4-year/8-semester bachelor's degree programme or programme or qualifications declared equivalent to the master's degree by the corresponding statutory regulatory body, with at least 75% marks [70% for SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, EWS] in aggregate or its equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed or equivalent qualification from a foreign educational institution accredited by an assessment and accreditation agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country to assess, accredit or assure quality and standards of the educational institution. 5.1.3. Candidates who have completed the M.Phil. programme with at least 55% marks [50% for SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, EWS] in aggregate or its equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed or equivalent qualification from a foreign educational institution accredited by an assessment and accreditation agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country to assess, accredit or assure quality and standards of educational institutions, shall be eligible for admission to the Ph.D. programme.

	5.3. Occasionally the university finds candidates with less than 55% in MSc with extraordinary research aptitude and idea, may be considered for admission subject to a critical evaluation of the claim of high order of research of aptitude by the URC. On recommendation of such candidate by URC, the Vice Chancellor may at his discretion permit admission of such candidate.	
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Clause No	Existing	Revised													
6. ADTU RESEARCH ENTRANCE TEST (ADTU-RET) AND PUBLICATION OF RESULT Clause no. 6.1.7.	6.1.7. Written test: The written examination comprises sixty (60) marks. Table 2 below shows the details of the written examination along with allocations of marks for the written examination: Table 2: Components of PhD -RET & Mark distribution <table> <tr> <th>Sl. No</th><th>Name of the subcomponents</th><th>Marks</th></tr> <tr> <td>(i)</td><td>Subject Specific Questions</td><td>Twenty (20)</td></tr> <tr> <td>(ii)</td><td>Basics of Computer</td><td rowspan="3">Forty (40)</td></tr> <tr> <td>(iii)</td><td>Basics of English Language</td></tr> <tr> <td>(iv)</td><td>Basics of Research Methodology</td></tr> </table> Note: MCQ type questions will be set for all the above four subcomponents.	Sl. No	Name of the subcomponents	Marks	(i)	Subject Specific Questions	Twenty (20)	(ii)	Basics of Computer	Forty (40)	(iii)	Basics of English Language	(iv)	Basics of Research Methodology	6.1.7. Written test: The written examination comprises seventy (70) marks. The written examination syllabus shall consist of 50% of research methodology, and 50% shall be subject specific. Students who have secured 50% marks in the entrance test are eligible to be called for the interview. A relaxation of 5 % marks will be allowed in the entrance examination for the candidates belonging to SC/ST/OBC/differently-abled category, Economically Weaker Section (EWS), and other categories of candidates as per the decision of the Commission from time to time. University may decide the number of eligible students to be called for an interview based on the number of Ph.D. seats available.
Sl. No	Name of the subcomponents	Marks													
(i)	Subject Specific Questions	Twenty (20)													
(ii)	Basics of Computer	Forty (40)													
(iii)	Basics of English Language														
(iv)	Basics of Research Methodology														
6. ADTU RESEARCH ENTRANCE TEST (ADTU-RET) AND PUBLICATION OF RESULT Clause no. 6.1.9.	6.1.9. The assessment through personal interaction will be based on 40 marks. The interaction will be conducted by the concerned FRC based on the candidate's application. The interaction will include a mandatory presentation by the candidate on a tentative research topic/idea of his/her chosen field. The FRC of the concerned faculty conducting the interaction of the candidates for admission into the Ph. D programme shall also be responsible for allocation of the Supervisors to the students on the basis of available seats within the limit of number of PhD research scholars under the eligible faculty member.	6.1.9. The assessment through personal interaction will be based on 30 marks. The interaction will be conducted by the concerned FRC based on the candidate's application. The interaction will include a mandatory presentation by the candidate on a tentative research topic/idea of his/her chosen field. The FRC of the concerned faculty conducting the interaction of the candidates for admission into the Ph.D programme shall also be responsible for allocation of the Supervisors to the students on the basis of available seats within the limit of number of PhD research scholars under the eligible faculty member.													

Clause No	Existing	Revised
6. ADTU RESEARCH ENTRANCE TEST (ADTU-RET) AND PUBLICATION OF RESULT Clause no. 6.1.10	6.1.10. The combined pass mark for the two components, i.e., written test and personal interaction together are fifty (50) out of the total marks of one hundred (100), subject to condition that the candidate secured more than 50% marks in the personal interaction segment for consideration of selection.	6.1.10. Selection of candidates based on the entrance test conducted by the AdtU, a weightage of 70% for the written test and 30% for the performance in the Interview/Personal interaction shall be given.
6. ADTU RESEARCH ENTRANCE TEST (ADTU-RET) AND PUBLICATION OF RESULT Clause no. 6.2.	6.2. Exemption from Entrance test: The candidates who have qualified UGC/CSIR-NET/(JRF) including SLET/SET or passed M.Phil. Degrees (through regular mode only) in the concerned subject are exempted from the written examination of AdtU-RET. However, they shall have to appear in counseling for getting admission into the program.	6.2. Exemption from Entrance test: The candidates who have qualified who qualify for fellowship/scholarship in UGC-NET/UGC- CSIR NET/GATE/ GPAT/CEED and similar National level tests based on an interview in the concerned subject are exempted from the written examination of AdtU-RET. However, they shall have to appear in counselling for getting admission into the program.

Clause No	Existing	Revised
7. RECOGNITION & ALLOCATION OF RESEARCH SUPERVISOR:	7.1. Eligibility criteria of PhD Supervisor for Faculty of Paramedical Science and Faculty of Nursing are as follows: 7.1.1. Any regular Professor having 2 (two) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed/UGC CARE/MCI indexed listed journals with atleast1 (one) publication during the last 5 (five) years, shall be eligible. 7.1.2. Any regular Associate Professor/Assistant Professor with PhD degree and 2 (two) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed/ UGC CARE/ MCI indexed listed journals with atleast 1 (one) publication during the last 5 (five) years and with at least one year post-PhD teaching/research/industrial experience, shall be eligible. 7.2. Eligibility criteria of PhD Supervisor for Faculty of Pharmaceutical Science, Faculty of Science, Faculty of Engineering & Technology, Faculty of	7.1. Permanent faculty members working as Professor/Associate Professor of the Higher Educational Institution with a Ph.D., and at least five research publications in peer-reviewed or refereed journals and permanent faculty members working as Assistant Professors in Higher Educational Institutions with a Ph.D., and at least three research publications in peer-reviewed or refereed journals may be recognized as a Research Supervisor in the university. 7.2. In case of interdisciplinary/multidisciplinary research work, if required, a Supervisor (outside AdtU, in addition to main Supervisor from AdtU) from outside the Department/School/Centre/College/University may be appointed. 7.3. An eligible Professor/Associate Professor/Assistant Professor can guide up to eight (8) / six (6) / four (4) Ph.D. scholars, respectively, at any given time. 7.4. In case of relocation of a female Ph.D. scholar due to marriage or otherwise, the research data shall be allowed to be transferred to the Higher Educational Institution to which the scholar intends to relocate, provided all the other conditions in these Regulations are followed, and the research work does not pertain to a project sanctioned to the parent Institution/Supervisor by any funding agency. Such scholar shall, however, give due credit to the parent institution and the supervisor for the part of research already undertaken. 7.5. Faculty members with less than three years of service before superannuation shall not be allowed to take new research scholars under their supervision.

Humanities and Social Science, Faculty of Commerce & Management is as follows: 7.2.1. Any regular Professor having 4 (four) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed / UGC CARE listed journals with atleast 3 (three) publications during the last 5 (five) years, shall be eligible. 7.2.2. Any regular Associate Professor/Assistant Professor with PhD degree and 4 (four) research paper publications in peer reviewed Scopus/SCI indexed / UGC CARE listed journals with atleast 3 (three) publications during the last 5 (five) years, and with at least one year of post-PhD teaching/research/industrial experience, shall be eligible.	However, such faculty members can continue to supervise Ph.D. scholars who are already registered until superannuation and as a co-supervisor after superannuation, but not after attaining the age of 70 years. 7.6. Each supervisor can guide up to two international research scholars on a supernumerary basis over and above the permitted number of Ph.D. scholars as specified in clause 7.3 above. 7.7. At any point, the total number of Ph.D. scholars under a faculty member, either as a supervisor or a co-supervisor, shall not exceed the number prescribed in clause 7.3 and clause 7.6.
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Clause No	Existing	Revised									
9. COURSE WORK		Course structure of the PhD Course Work									
		Course no.	Name of the course	Mode	Teaching Hours						Credit (C)
					L	T	P	S	R	O/F	
		Course - I	Research Methodology	Common to all disciplines/ departments	3	0	0	0	0	0	3
		Course - II	Statistical Methods & Computer Application	Common to all disciplines/ departments	2	0	2	0	0	0	3 (2+1)
		Course - III	Research and Publication Ethics	Common to all disciplines/ departments	1	0	2	0	0	0	2 (1+1)
		Course - IV	Instrumental Tools and Methods	Discipline/ department specific	2	0	4	0	0	0	4 (2+2)
		Course - V	Literature Survey	Discipline/ department specific	0	0	0	0	12	0	2
		Total			8	0	8	0	12	0	14
		L, Lecture (7); T, Tutorial (1); P, Practice/ Practical; S, Skill; R, Research (10); O, Outreach; Considering minimum 15 week									
L(8) + P (8) = 16 hrs = 16 x 15 weeks = 240 hrs [1 week x 7 hr = 42 hrs x 5 week											

Clause No	Existing	Revised
11. SIX MONTHLY PROGRESS REPORT OF RESEARCH WORK	11.4. A minimum of five half yearly PhD research work progress reports of the scholar, which are duly approved by the FRC, is a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission of one PhD scholar thesis.	11.4. A minimum of four half yearly PhD research work progress reports of the scholar, which are duly approved by the FRC, is a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission of one PhD scholar thesis.
17. ACADEMIC PRE-REQUISITE FOR PRE-SUBMISSION PRESENTATION:	17.1. A minimum of five consecutive half yearly progress reports of the scholar, all duly approved by the FRC, will be a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission presentation of his/her thesis. 17.2. Every scholar has to publish at least one Research Paper on his/her research work in a UGCCARE listed journal before the pre-submission presentation and produce evidence to that affect, in the form of a reprint or acceptance letter. However, for those disciplines which do not have any UGC-CARE listed journal, the concerned Department/FRC will prepare a list of journals and submit it through the concerned FRC to the URC for approval. 17.3. Every research scholar must make two paper presentations in conferences/seminars (national/international), before the pre-submission presentation, and produce evidence for the same in the form of certificates and/or reprints.	17.1. A minimum of four consecutive half yearly progress reports of the scholar, all duly approved by the FRC, will be a necessary pre-requisite for pre-submission presentation of his/her thesis. 17.2. Scholar has to publish minimum of three (03) journal papers from his/her PhD work a. At least one (01) article should be published in Impact Factor Journal (Thomson Reuters-Clarivate Analytics Journal Citation Reports). b. One (01) article should be published in Scopus/Web of Science indexed journal or in journals specified in (a). c. One article (01) in Annals of Multidisciplinary Research, Innovation and Technology (AMRIT) Journal or in journals specified in (a) or (b). d. With respect to the nature of published articles, at least 2 must be research articles out of 3 articles. 17.3. Scholar has to make one (01) research work presentation related to his/her PhD work in international conference/seminar.
18. PRE-SUBMISSION PRESENTATION:	18.1. Prior to submission of Abstract and the thesis, a scholar has to give a pre-submission presentation on his/her entire work highlighting the findings (chapter wise), in presence of the concerned FRC. The presence of Supervisor(s) is mandatory in the presentation	18.1. Prior to submission of Abstract and the thesis, a scholar has to give a pre-submission presentation on his/her entire work highlighting the findings (chapter wise), in presence of the concerned FRC. The presence of Supervisor(s) is mandatory in the presentation. Pre-submission seminar which shall also be open to all faculty members and other research scholars/students.
28. DURATION OF PROGRAMME:	28.1. PhD. programme shall be for a minimum duration of three years, including course work and a maximum of six years for full time research scholars. 28.2. The maximum duration of the PhD programme for a part-time student will be seven (7) years, counted from the date of admission to the date of submission of thesis.	28.1 Ph.D. Programme shall be for a minimum duration of three (3) years, including course work, and a maximum duration of six (6) years from the date of admission to the Ph.D. programme. 28.2 A maximum of an additional two (2) years can be given through a process of re-registration as per the Statute/Ordinance of the Higher Educational Institution concerned; provided, however, that the total period for completion of a Ph.D. programme should not exceed eight (8) years from the date of admission in the Ph.D. programme. Provided further that, female Ph.D. scholars and Persons with Disabilities (having more than 40% disability) may be allowed an additional relaxation of two (2) years; however, the total period for completion of a Ph.D. programme in such cases should not exceed ten (10) years from the date of admission in the Ph.D. programme.

